



# Colour-Coded, Not Calmer

## A Survey of Reset-Chart Completion and Household Dispute Rates in the First Week of Term

Iben Chikere · Petra Umbile — School of Emergent Priorities

### The problem

Parenting programs send school-holiday households home with a fridge “reset chart” to tick off before term begins. Completion is easy to check. Whether it changes anything a family actually lives through the first week back is not.

### Aims

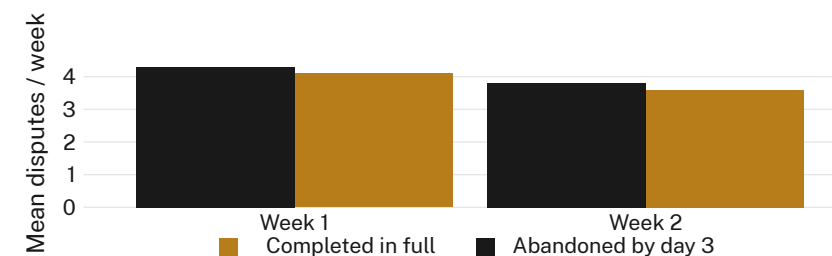
- Test whether chart completion predicts fewer week-one bedtime and screen-time disputes
- Compare parent self-report against an independent shared-calendar dispute log
- Establish whether the chart is a behaviour instrument or a fridge display

### Study design

- 214 households · three primary-school parent networks · self-report survey · a fortnight either side of term restart
- binary predictor: chart fully ticked vs abandoned by day 3 of the break
- outcome cross-checked against a 58-household subset’s shared family-calendar entries

### Findings

Households completing the chart in full logged 4.1 disputes in week one against 4.3 for those who abandoned it ( $p = 0.61$ ). Completion tracked fridge sticker density ( $r = 0.71$ ) rather than the week it was meant to smooth.



Mean weekly disputes held near-identical across completion groups in both post-term weeks ( $n = 214$ ;  $p = 0.61$ ) — a gap chart completion doesn’t explain.

### What it means

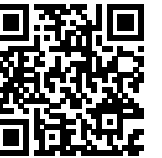
A fully ticked chart correlated with a more decorated fridge, not a quieter Monday. The instrument rewards its own completion. Next: test a chart built around a consequence, not a sticker count.

### Selected references

1. Gollwitzer, P. M. (1999). Implementation intentions: Strong effects of simple plans. *American Psychologist*, 54(7), 493–503. doi:10.1037/0003-066X.54.7.493
2. Michie, S., Richardson, M., Johnston, M., et al. (2013). The behavior change technique taxonomy (v1). *Annals of Behavioral Medicine*, 46(1), 81–95. doi:10.1007/s12160-013-9486-6
3. Haynes, A. B., Weiser, T. G., Berry, W. R., et al. (2009). A surgical safety checklist to reduce morbidity and mortality in a global population. *New England Journal of Medicine*, 360(5), 491–499. doi:10.1056/NEJMs0810119
4. Radesky, J. S., Schumacher, J., & Zuckerman, B. (2015). Mobile and interactive media use by young children: the good, the bad, and the unknown. *Pediatrics*, 135(1), 1–3. doi:10.1542/peds.2014-2251
5. Chikere, I., Tolan, A., & Lindqvist, K. (2026). The Form Held Up: A Failed Replication Attempt Testing Whether a Community Garden Allotment’s Handover-Form Completeness Predicts a Successor’s Retained Horticultural Knowledge. School of Emergent Priorities. doi:10.5555/slop.u8gsl4

Parent self-report only; no minors surveyed directly; fridge photographs consented and de-identified.

Office of Research Outputs · slop.university



“The fridge got busier. The house didn’t get quieter.”

Reset-chart completion tracked fridge sticker density, not week-one dispute counts ( $n = 214$  households).